

COMMUNICATION IN MANAGEMENT

- Communication is the sending and receiving of information and involves a sender who initiates communication and encodes, meaning transfers thoughts, into a message that is sent to the receiver, or the person who is meant to receive the communication, who must then decode, meaning interpret, the message.
- Communication refers to the process by which information is exchanged between two or more people. Managers must be able to receive accurate information to determine plans, and they must be able to send accurate information for the plans to be implemented. When information is accurately sent and received, everyone in an organization can be informed. However, when information is misinterpreted or when incorrect information spreads, communications can create significant problems in organizations.

The Role of Communication in Management

- The role of management is to accomplish the goals of an organization. To do this, managers create a plan that defines what needs to be done, when it will be done, and how it will be done. To implement the plan, managers must convey this information to everyone in the organization. That is, they must communicate the plan to members of the organization. However, managers need to do much more than just inform people what they need to do to support the plan. They also must motivate people to support the plan, build commitment to the organization, establish rapport and collaboration, and keep everyone informed of events and actions that affect the organization.
- Good communication not only informs but also helps to create a culture that makes people feel like they belong to and want to support the organization. The opening example shows what can result from poor communication. Following are some of the benefits of effective communication.
- Provides clarity. Confusion, uncertainty, and ambiguity make people uncomfortable and uncooperative. Making roles, responsibilities, and relationships clear gives everyone the information they need to do their jobs and to understand their contributions to the organization. Effective communication reduces the cost associated with conflicts, misunderstandings, and mistakes.
- Builds Relationships. A culture that promotes open communication reduces tension between hierarchical levels of employees, both professionally and socially. In a trusting and collaborative culture, people are more likely to seek help with problems and to suggest solutions and improvements. Effective communication creates a collegial culture that fosters teamwork and encourages cooperation.

- Creates commitment. Effective communication involves not only sending information but also receiving it. By listening to employees' concerns, allowing them to have input on their work and their workplace, and giving consideration to their suggestions, managers can make everyone in the organization feel like they are valued contributors. When employees feel like they are valued in the organization, they will likely be more engaged and motivated. Effective communication creates support and commitment.

The Communication-Process Model

- The communication process may seem simple: one person sends a message and others receive it. The process becomes more complex, however, because the information in the message must be sent and received accurately. The communication-process model describes how the information is sent and received.
- The following diagram shows this model.
- It is easiest to understand the model when one person is communicating with another person. The person initiating the communication, the sender, has information he wants the other person, the receiver, to know. However, before it can be sent, the information has to be encoded into a form that can be transmitted. In a simple case, the information is put into words spoken to the receiver or the information may be converted into printed text, tables, charts, or graphs given to the receiver. In a more complicated case, the information is encoded into words or images that are then converted into electronic signals sent to the receiver. The channel is the medium through which the information is conveyed. It could be air conveying sound waves, paper conveying text and images, or wires or magnetic fields conveying electronic signals.
- The receiver reverses the process. She receives the encoded message and then decodes it. That means she converts the message back into information that can be understood. In an interactive communication process, the receiver can send feedback to the sender to indicate that the message has been received and how it has been interpreted. This can start an interactive back-and-forth exchange that can assure the sender that the message has been received and understood correctly.

The Significance of Communication

- Organizations are totally reliant on communication, which is defined as the exchange of ideas, messages, or information by speech, signals, or writing. Without communication, organizations would not function. If communication is diminished or hampered, the entire organization suffers. When communication is thorough, accurate, and timely, the organization tends to be vibrant and effective. Communication is central to the entire management process for four primary reasons:

- Communication is a linking process of management. Communication is the way managers conduct the managerial functions of planning, organizing, staffing, directing, and controlling. Communication is the heart of all organizations
- Communication is the primary means by which people obtain and exchange information. Decisions are often dependent upon the quality and quantity of the information received. If the information on which a decision is based is poor or incomplete, the decision will often be incorrect.
- The most time-consuming activity a manager engages in is communication. Managers spend between 70 to 90 percent of their time communicating with employees and other internal and external customers.
- Information and communication represent power in organizations. An employee cannot do anything constructive in a work unit unless he or she knows what is to be done, when the task is to be accomplished, and who else is involved. The staff members who have this information become centers of power.
- The ability to communicate well, both orally and in writing, is a critical managerial skill and a foundation of effective leadership. Through communication, people exchange and share information and influence one another's attitudes, behaviors, and understandings. Communication allows managers to establish and maintain interpersonal relationships, listen to others, and otherwise gain the information needed to create an inspirational workplace. No manager can handle conflict, negotiate successfully, and succeed at leadership without being a good communicator.

Management communication: Definition and best practices to follow in the workplace

- Effective communication is the backbone of any successful organization, and in this blog, we will define management communication, examine its key elements, and share best practices to improve it in your workplace.
- Management communication is the linchpin that connects top-level management with the rest of the team, providing clarity, transparency, and unity. Picture a workplace where managers keep the team updated on project progress, actively seek feedback, and make everyone feel valued! This is what effective management communication can achieve.

What is the importance of management communication in the workplace?

- Effective management communication plays a pivotal role in fostering clarity, transparency, and unity within an organization. Good communication enables managers to convey and communicate their vision, expectations, and strategies to their teams

while also creating channels for employees to express their thoughts, concerns, and ideas.

- The key reasons why management communication is important:
- Clarity and direction: It provides clear directions, expectations, and goals to employees. When everyone understands management roles and what is expected of them, they can work more efficiently and effectively.
- Transparency: It fosters transparency by keeping employees informed about organizational changes, strategies, and decisions. This transparency builds trust and reduces uncertainty.
- Employee engagement: Effective communication makes employees feel valued and engaged. They are more likely to contribute ideas, ask questions, and participate actively when they know their voices are heard.
- Conflict resolution: It serves as a platform for resolving conflicts, exchange information, and addressing issues. Open communication channels allow problems to be identified and resolved quickly, preventing them from escalating.
- Enhanced productivity: When there is clarity in communication, employees waste less time deciphering vague messages or seeking clarification. This boosts overall productivity.
- Team cohesion: Management communication brings teams together by providing a shared understanding of their roles and responsibilities, encouraging collaboration and unity.
- Motivation: Well-communicated goals and achievements can motivate employees. Recognizing and celebrating successes can boost morale and motivation.
- Risk management: It helps in risk management by conveying important information related to compliance, safety, and ethical conduct. This reduces the likelihood of legal and reputational issues.
- In summary, management communication is the backbone of a harmonious, productive workplace. It ensures that employees are well-informed, engaged, and working towards common goals, ultimately contributing to the organization's success and sustainability.
- Ultimately, it ensures that everyone is on the same page, which is vital for achieving organizational and business success.

What are the key management communication elements?

- Effective management communication is built on a foundation of key elements that promote understanding, alignment, and engagement within an organization. The key management elements of communication refers to:
- Consistency: Consistency in communication helps build trust. When employees receive consistent messages, they feel more secure and confident in their roles.
- Active listening: It's not just about speaking but also about listening. Managers should pay attention to employees' concerns and feedback, making them feel valued.
- Feedback mechanisms: Establishing channels for feedback is essential. This can include regular team meetings, suggestion boxes, or digital platforms.
- Clarity: Messages must be clear and concise. Ambiguity can lead to misunderstandings, errors, and frustration.

What are the 7 C's of organizational communication?

- The 7 C's of organizational communication are a set of principles that help ensure effective and clear communication within an organization:
 1. Clarity: Information should be clear, concise, and easy to understand. Avoid jargon or ambiguity that might lead to misunderstandings.
 2. Conciseness: Messages should be brief and to the point, conveying essential information without unnecessary details.
 3. Coherence: Ensure that your verbal communication always follows a logical and organized structure. It should flow in a way that makes sense to the recipient.
 4. Consistency: Maintain uniformity in messaging and branding to prevent confusion. Consistency in the message and communication builds trust and credibility.
 5. Correctness: Accuracy is crucial. Always verify the information you're sharing to avoid errors or misinformation.
 6. Consideration: Be considerate of the needs and perspectives of your audience. Tailor your message and communication to their interests and concerns.
 7. Completeness: Communication should provide all necessary and accurate information. Incomplete messages can lead to misunderstandings or the need for additional follow-up communications.

Common management communication issues that lead to attrition

- Several common management communication issues can contribute to employee attrition. Addressing these issues is crucial to retaining talent and maintaining a healthy workplace:
- Lack of clarity
- When managers fail to communicate clear expectations, job roles, or project objectives, employees and many managers may become frustrated or disengaged. Unclear or poor communication often can lead to misunderstandings and job dissatisfaction, prompting some to leave.
- Limited feedback and recognition
- Employees who don't receive regular feedback or recognition for their efforts may feel undervalued. Effective communication should include acknowledging and celebrating employees' achievements, which helps in retaining talent.
- Ignoring employee concerns
- When employees raise concerns or provide feedback, and those concerns are dismissed or not addressed, it can lead to frustration and a lack of trust in project manager. Employees might start looking for a more receptive work environment.
- Inconsistent communication
- Inconsistencies in communication, especially about organizational changes or expectations, can lead to confusion and a sense of instability among employees. This can be demoralizing and contribute to attrition.
- Lack of opportunities for growth
- If employees perceive a lack of communication about career development opportunities, they may seek positions elsewhere that offer clearer paths for advancement.
- Ineffective conflict resolution
- Poorly managed conflicts within the workplace can result in unresolved tensions, causing many employees to leave to escape a toxic work environment. Effective communication is essential for addressing and resolving conflicts.
- No open door policy
- When employees don't feel comfortable approaching management with concerns or ideas, they may feel unheard or unsupported. Establishing an open-door policy can encourage employees to stay and engage.

- Poor onboarding and orientation
- Insufficient or ineffective communication during onboarding and orientation can make new employees feel disconnected and unprepared. This initial lack of engagement can set the stage for attrition.
- Ignoring work-life balance
- Failure to address work-life balance issues can lead to burnout and attrition. Effective communication should include discussions about managing workload and promoting a healthy work-life balance.
- Failure to adapt to remote work
- In the era of remote work, not adapting communication strategies for remote employees can result in disengagement and attrition. Ensuring clear and consistent remote communication is vital.
- Addressing these workplace communication issues by fostering open, transparent, and supportive communication practices can help reduce attrition and create a more engaged and satisfied workforce.

Communication in our daily lives

- Communication is all around us. It requires constant interaction. It happens when we order coffee or hail a jeepney. It happens when we write an important memo, or greet people.
- Communication is the transfer of information in any form. Without it, we wouldn't be able to convey our thoughts and our messages to another person. When we tell the barista the kind of coffee we like, or tell someone how much they mean to us, we are communicating.
- There are many parts in communication. There's a sender and the message. There's the medium, the receiver, and feedback.
- The general goal of communication is to create understanding. We achieve shared meaning when one party receives the message the way the sender intended, and responds. Research shows that some relationships effectively rely on effective communication.

What are communication barriers?

- Even the best communicators have been misunderstood at some point. This happens when the message is not delivered the way the sender meant to.

- For example, you failed to wave your hand at a jeepney driver to signal that you wish to ride. Because of this, you miss the ride. You don't get to your destination on time. Or you send a memo to your staff and don't get the response you were hoping for. These are examples of miscommunication.
- Communication barriers cause miscommunication. They prevent us from understanding messages as the senders intend. Not enough information and a lack of empathy could also lead to miscommunication. Sometimes, not having good communication skills can cause these problems.

What causes communication barriers?

- Differences in language and culture
- Miscommunication can happen when we don't know much about the other person's background. Language and cultural differences are common communication barriers.
- If a foreigner needs to ask for directions from someone who doesn't speak the same language, there could be misunderstanding. In fact, a study found that 10% of adults don't travel because of language barriers.
- Language barriers, adaptability, and cultural values also play roles in business communication. They affect how employees negotiate and interact.
- Barriers of the physical environment
- Your location can also pose problems with how you communicate with someone. Two employees on different floors might find it challenging to collaborate on a project because of their location.
- In his proposed rule, anthropologist and researcher Edward Hall said the ideal distance for effective workplace interactions is between 1.2 to 3.6 meters. Beyond that, communication might be ineffective.
- Differences in perception
- Perception barriers, like attitudes, can affect communication. Having different beliefs and experiences are examples of a perception barrier. If your office manager constantly disagrees with you or rejects your suggestions, it may be because they don't like you. To avoid confusion and misunderstanding, ask your manager directly about the reason behind it.
- Attitude

- Our attitude can be another communication barrier. We can miscommunicate when we make assumptions and use stereotypes based on our limited or inaccurate knowledge.
- When a company hires a staff member with a disability, some employees might avoid talking to them. Sometimes, they worry about hurting their feelings.
- A lack of clarity can cause misunderstanding. Employees should be trained to communicate effectively with people with disabilities.
- Emotional and psychological conditions
- If you're not feeling well or have a health problem, it can affect how well you can communicate. You'll find it hard to send or receive information.
- Even in ordinary situations, strong emotions can create communication barriers. Emotions such as anger, fear, or pride can affect your decision making. When you are calm and relaxed, you'll be able to communicate better.

2 types of communication barriers and their examples

- Understand the causes of communication barriers to communicate effectively in any situation. This will help you identify the different types of barriers and find ways to overcome them.
- Below are common examples of communication barriers.
- **Verbal barriers**
 1. Language barriers - Linguistic limitations happen when people can't understand each other because they speak different languages. It's a common barrier to verbal communication.
 2. Lack of clarity and conciseness - Despite speaking the same language, people can find it hard to understand each other. This is because of unclear speech. Factors include nervousness or even medical conditions.
 3. Use of jargon and technical terms - Using words that require a higher or specific level of understanding can lead to the person not receiving the message well. This can happen even within the same language.
 4. Tone and style - The way we deliver words can mean different things. It can affect how other people understand what we want to say.
- **Non-verbal barriers**

1. Body language and gestures - Without saying anything, we show our feelings and intentions through our movements. Fidgeting or constant movement can signal that someone may be lying. This can lead to conflicts in relationships.
2. Facial expressions - Our faces show our emotions better than any language. Lowering the brow, for example, can mean you're angry or in a bad mood. This can make others avoid talking to you.
3. Eye contact - We look at someone's eyes to show confidence. We may be paying attention, but this may also seem threatening. But avoiding eye contact may mean discomfort, disrespect, or shyness.
4. Distance and physical space - The farther we are from the person receiving our message, the harder we can communicate. This is because there are fewer available platforms. Speaking directly with others is the best way to communicate.

- **Written barriers**

1. Poor grammar and spelling - Having a common language doesn't guarantee understanding. The wrong words and phrasing can also lead to misunderstanding. This is why it's also important to use proper language, despite your culture.
2. Incorrect use of punctuation - Text symbols, from commas to exclamation points, give different meanings. The wrong use of symbols can prevent the receiver from understanding a message.
3. Lack of organization and coherence - Clear, organized sentences are important in effective communication. Make your messages logical and flowing. This makes messages easier to understand than those that lack structure.
4. Poor handwriting or typewriting - Write in a clear, readable manner to avoid confusion. A lot of effective communication depends on how well writing tools and materials are used.

How to overcome communication barriers

- You can overcome communication barriers even though it might not seem possible. Consider the condition of the sender, receiver, location, and timing of communication. Use strategies that reduce or avoid these barriers. Using the right strategy is important.
- Improve language and cultural competence

- Many communication barriers exist because of differences in cultural background. Solve this by working on growing your knowledge of different cultures. Watch documentaries and films about other cultures. Take language classes, stay updated on global news, or befriend people from different countries.
- Expose yourself to different languages and cultures, so you can eventually expand your communication skills. It won't happen instantly, so be patient.
- Choose appropriate communication channels
- According to communication expert Marshall McLuhan, the "medium is the message." This principle shows how the platform we use to deliver messages influences how others interpret them.
- Rather than speaking directly to someone you have a conflict with, we can write down our message. This way, you can delay our response and adjust our wording. Try your best to sound neutral. You can avoid making the situation worse.
- You should also adjust our tone and language when posting on Facebook, as opposed to posting on LinkedIn. The former tends to be more casual and candid. The latter uses a more professional approach.
- Use clear and concise language
- On top of learning languages, you can also improve your communication by enhancing your existing knowledge. To grab someone's attention, use specific terms or precise words to make yourself appear more intelligent. You can create more impact this way.
- Note, however, that this can sometimes lead to miscommunication. This is because you are trying to distort or conceal the thoughts that you really want to share.
- To avoid this, simplify the way you speak by using everyday words and sentences. Instead of "egocentric," say "selfish." Instead of "a dime a dozen," just say "common." It is better when you say it simpler.
- Be an active listener
- Active listening is one of the best ways to improve communication. Pay close attention to what someone is saying, so you can choose the best ways to respond to them. This allows you to reach mutual understanding.
- Showing that you make an effort to listen and truly comprehend someone's message also shows that you value his or her time. Doing this achieves more trust, transparency,

and respect between you and other people. These values are essential in building strong personal and professional relationships.

- Be mindful of non-verbal cues
- Remember the old saying that actions speak louder than words? This holds true up to this day. Even employers use non-verbal cues to assess job seekers during interviews. Non-verbal cues are still important, even in the age of online communication platforms. Don't underestimate the significance of non-verbal communication.
- Study who you are speaking to. It is the best way to avoid barriers caused by the misuse of these cues. Gain firsthand understanding by immersing yourself in diverse groups and cultures. Ask questions to confirm that you're conveying or receiving the correct message.
- Clarify and confirm understanding
- Asking questions is one of the first steps in preventing communication barriers. You gain a better understanding of what the message sender is trying to say. In turn, the sender will know if their intended message was correctly received by the other party.
- Besides studying non-verbal cues and listening, asking questions is an important part of overcoming communication barriers. It means being curious, keeping an open mind, and asking questions to avoid misunderstanding.
- Practice empathy
- Empathy is the ability to share and understand another person's feelings and emotions. When talking to a coworker going through personal challenges, be more sensitive by adjusting your approach. Be calm instead of aggressive. Use phrases like "I'm sorry you feel this way."
- Learn to observe, listen, and set aside your own biases on a situation. You can ask questions to attain clarity and understanding. This will help you become more empathetic, and will help you communicate better.

Workplace communication barriers

- Communication barriers in the workplace often stem from differences in social status, job roles, gender, or language. Additionally, poorly designed offices, malfunctioning equipment, and inadequate lighting and ventilation add to these barriers. If not addressed, these barriers lead to conflicts, slow down productivity and efficiency, and impact overall performance.

- Intercultural communication barriers
- Cultural differences create communication challenges. Ethnic stereotypes can hinder intercultural understanding. These barriers can lead to harmful misunderstanding.

Communication barriers in specific contexts

- Communication barriers happen anytime and anywhere. Depending on the context or environment, these barriers can have a unique impact on everyone involved. When you know how to overcome communication barriers, you will know how the barriers work in different settings. This will help you find out the best ways to work and communicate.
- Here are some examples:
- Family communication barriers
- Like groups of workers, families are made up of multiple personalities, preferences, and ages and genders. These differences can present many challenges among family members who spend much of their time together.
- In the Philippines, we are taught not to talk back to our parents when they reprimand us for something we did wrong. This is considered rude. But this impedes communication. We often fail to share our side. This prevents them from understanding us more. This also brings about a serious communication challenge in a family setting.
- Healthcare communication barriers
- Communication barriers are also common in the medical field. Patients with serious conditions tend to have limited ability to convey their feelings or requests to their doctors and nurses. Some patients also have a hard time understanding instructions from their healthcare provider. To overcome these barriers, hospitals resort to certain machines and other aids. A study shows that more than 50% of patients in ventilators require assistive communication tools and speech-language therapy.
- Education communication barriers
- Language challenges create communication barriers that affect student growth and teachers' efficiency. Studies also show that struggles in the vocabulary, grammar, and pronunciation in young students affect their academic performance.
- In Philippine schools, 9 out of 10 young Filipino students struggle to understand learning materials. This affects their academic work.

SENIORITY IN THE WORKPLACE

- Seniority at work has many advantages for an employee, both on the job and in their personal lives. Remaining loyal to a company may increase the perks you receive or affect how you structure your daily responsibilities. Learning the function of seniority structures can help you decide if gaining seniority with your company is worth pursuing. In this article, we explain what a seniority definition at work is, review its benefits and discuss different industries that use this framework.

What does seniority mean at work?

- Seniority is the extended continuous service with a company or organization. This means that people who have worked at a company the longest have the highest level of seniority. Those with more history may be able to get a higher rank or status within their company and may enjoy additional privileges. Employees with seniority often have the first chance to claim or accept benefits, though people at other levels in the organization may earn the same perks through different strategies or means. The regulations surrounding seniority may differ from company to company, but working in the same organization for several years can earn anyone seniority.

Why is seniority important?

- Executives often consider seniority when adjusting the company's reporting structure or responsibilities. They may also take into account job performance, adherence to deadlines, and relationships with coworkers. In situations where two employees have nearly identical credentials, seniority may be used as the deciding factor for which employee receives the benefits or advancement.

Entry-level

- Entry-level positions are usually the lowest level of seniority. These jobs are suitable for people who have just graduated from school, are starting a career in a new field or who choose to work part time. Employees at this level focus on learning and gaining experience in their industry and understanding the operations of their new company. Entry-level employees typically report to a supervisor who directly oversees their work and represents a higher management structure. These employees may also receive mentoring from their supervisors. Some entry-level career choices include:
 - Bank teller
 - Customer service specialist
 - Human resources coordinator
 - Junior accountant

- Management trainee
 - Payroll clerk
 - Recruiting assistant
 - Training specialist
- Typical characteristics include:
 - Less than 2 years of experience.
 - Juniors need help with their work and may not have all the tools they need to do their job.
 - They are not experts in the business or its processes.
 - Often, their work needs to be defined, and they wait for new applications.
 - Also, their work depends on the approval of others and is closely followed to avoid mistakes.
 - These professionals often become blocked or stressed when they face a stressful situation.

Mid-level

- Mid-level employees typically have established experience and have worked for their current company or industry for five or more years. They may serve as supervisors for entry-level employees but also report to a manager or senior-level executive. Within the mid-level, there is a subsection called the mid-senior level. People with this seniority distinction may have authority over other mid-level employees but also still report to another manager. Some mid-level jobs include:
 - Administrative technician
 - Executive assistant
 - Facilities manager
 - Office manager
 - Operations manager
 - Physician assistant
 - Team leader

- Ultrasound technician
- Some characteristics include:
 - These professionals have 2 to 6 years of experience.
 - A semi-senior professional is self-sufficient. They can develop more complex functionality and run larger activities. At this point, the person already knows and understands the company's processes.
 - This professional has more experience and can identify enhancements and work on new requirements while addressing any pending task.
 - They can respond to a pressure situation but need help from their work team.

Senior-level

- Senior-level employees may also go by the title of executive-level employees or C-level executives. These positions require a high level of experience in the field, usually eight years or more, and a history of repeated exceptional performance. This seniority level has the most responsibility and often works without supervision. Instead, they may work with peers to decide about certain situations or issues within the company. Some senior-level jobs include:
 - Chief executive officer (CEO)
 - Chief financial officer (CFO)
 - Chief information officer (CIO)
 - Chief marketing officer (CMO)
 - Chief operating officer (COO)
 - Executive director
 - Vice president
- Typical characteristics include:
 - These professionals have 6 years of experience or more.
 - Senior professionals become a reference for many people within the company. Their knowledge allows them to work or collaborate on more challenging and important projects for the company.

- They understand the processes already established in the company and help innovate them or define processes and methodologies from scratch. It is self-sufficient and can oversee one or more people.
- Senior professionals must take charge of the situation and overcome it despite the difficulties. They are committed to the cause and stand up to it with enthusiasm for the sake of success.
- They not only receive requirements but also generate them. And on many occasions, they are the ones who bring new initiatives to the company to improve its operation.

Is a seniority system legal?

- Seniority systems within an organization are completely legal. Collective agreements with trade unions or within a particular organization may make the rules about these types of hierarchical structures. With seniority systems, employees are discouraged from competing for perks, such as by doing favours for supervisors. They are also meant to prevent unethical behaviour, such as discrimination or unfair promotion of friends and family members to senior positions.